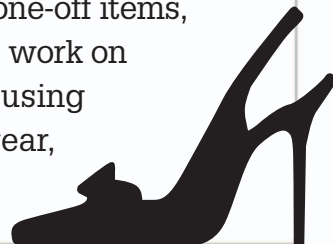




FASHION DESIGNER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Fashion designers create clothing, shoes, and other accessories. They use their creative expertise and knowledge of textiles, sewing, and manufacturing processes to set trends in color, fabric, and style. Those designers with a high profile often specialize in creating expensive one-off items, whereas the majority of designers work on clothing for the mass market, focusing on certain lines, such as sportswear, men's suits, or knitwear.



SALARY

Junior designer ★★★★★

Head of design ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Market dominated by small- to medium- sized fashion houses located in large cities • Jobs in high fashion (*haute couture*), ready-to-wear (*prêt-à-porter*), and mass-market retail

CAREER PATHS

This is a highly competitive industry. A degree isn't necessarily required to earn your first break, but you do need to show evidence of your interest and talent, such as a portfolio of fashion sketches, and have lots of determination. With experience, you can reach more senior creative positions in a fashion house or clothing manufacturer, or even start your own business.

ASSISTANT If you are a naturally gifted designer, work experience in a retail store or hands-on dressmaking skills will attract employers. With talent, a good portfolio, and internship experience, you may gain an entry-level job in fashion design.

GRADUATE Studying for a degree in fashion or textile design will develop your skills and teach you the technical and business aspects of clothing design, which will greatly improve your chances of finding a job in the industry.



SPECIALIZED DESIGNER

Focuses on designing clothes for a specific area of the industry, such as menswear, footwear, or swimwear.



FASHION DESIGNER In the beginning, you work on specific design products to fill an identified gap in the market. Creative freedom comes with seniority, or when you start your own company or label.

